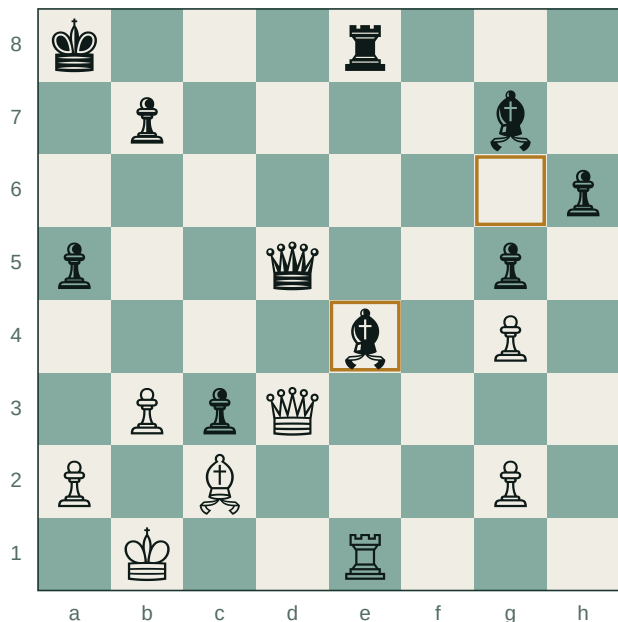


Queenside attacks: White, move 40

Queenside attacks

White to move



Previous move: 39...Bxe4. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

40. Qxd5 Bxd5 41. Rxe8+

40.Qxd5 The queen captures the queen on d5. The changed line means the bishop on c2 attacks the bishop on e4.
Recorded reply: **40...Bxd5**.

41.Rxe8+ Check restricts Black to 1 legal reply here. The move also takes the rook on e8.

At the end, nominal material is White 12 / Black 11 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +5. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +5:** the balance goes from -4 to +1. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

The board's left half is not inherently safe. Queen checks and rook entries can make a queenside king as vulnerable as a kingside one.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

An attack on the queenside can target a castled king, a vulnerable pawn, or trapped pieces. Files and entry squares matter more than simply advancing flank pawns.

HOW TO LOOK

Locate the critical target and which pawn or piece move opens a route toward it. Check whether central counterplay interrupts the plan.

The defending king is on a8. Geometrically undefended: rook on e8 and bishop on g7. Check for tactical protection.